Employee Leave & Code of Conduct Policy

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DOCUMENT CONTROL & GOVERNANCE SUMMARY

Document Ref:	POL-HR-002	**Effective Date:**	2026-01-01
Policy Owner:	Head of Employee Relations &…	**Next Review:**	2027-01-01
Approver:	Executive Board / Chief Human…	**Version:**	v1.0
Scope / Audience:	All Full-Time, Probationary &…	**Classification:**	Internal Policy

1. LEGAL DISCLAIMER & GOVERNANCE PREAMBLE

Please note: This template policy is for informational purposes only and does not constitute formal legal advice. It is a corporate governance template designed to align with Acas guidance, POSH regulations, and international employment laws. Organizations customizing this document should seek qualified legal review.

Our Organization is committed to sustaining a respectful, equitable, and ethical work culture. This policy establishes the framework for annual leave entitlements, professional conduct standards, anti-harassment safeguards, conflict of interest prohibitions, and progressive disciplinary governance.

2. CODE OF PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT & WORKPLACE ETHICS

1.1 Workplace Demeanor & Integrity:
Employees must uphold the highest standards of honesty, integrity, professional demeanor, and mutual respect in all interactions with colleagues, customers, and partners.

1.2 Diversity, Equity & Non-Discrimination:
The company maintains zero tolerance for discrimination, bias, or harassment based on race, color, gender, age, religion, national origin, disability, sexual orientation, or marital status.

1.3 Professional Attire & Representation:
Employees are expected to maintain professional business casual attire Monday through Thursday, with smart casual attire permitted on Fridays.

1.4 Protection of Intellectual Property & Confidentiality:
All proprietary source code, trade secrets, financial records, client lists, and strategic business data remain strictly confidential during and post-employment.

3. PAID LEAVE CATEGORIES, ENTITLEMENTS & ACCRUAL RULES

2.1 Casual Leave (CL):
Employees accrue 12 days of paid Casual Leave annually (1 day per completed month), intended for short-term urgent personal matters. CL cannot exceed 3 consecutive working days per instance.

2.2 Sick Leave (SL):
Employees accrue 12 days of paid Sick Leave annually for personal medical recovery. Medical certificates signed by a licensed physician are mandatory for SL exceeding 2 consecutive days.

2.3 Earned Leave (EL / Vacation):
Employees accrue 15 days of Earned Leave annually (1.25 days per month), available upon completing 6 months of probation. Minimum requested duration is 3 consecutive days.

2.4 Statutory Maternity & Paternity Benefits:
Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave in accordance with statutory acts. Male employees are entitled to 15 consecutive days of paid Paternity Leave within 6 months of childbirth.

2.5 Bereavement Leave:
Employees receive 5 days of paid Bereavement Leave upon the demise of an immediate family member.

4. LEAVE REQUEST TIMELINES & APPROVAL WORKFLOWS

3.1 Advance Planned Leave Notice SLA:
Requests for Earned Leave or continuous time off exceeding 2 days must be submitted in HRIS at least 7 calendar days prior to the start date.

3.2 Emergency Sick Leave Notification:
Sudden illness must be reported to line managers via phone/email by 09:00 AM on the morning of absence.

3.3 Managerial Operational Coverage Review:
Managers evaluate leave applications based on team project deadlines, operational coverage requirements, and existing coverage schedules.

5. YEAR-END CARRY-FORWARD, LAPSING & ENCASHMENT RULES

4.1 Lapsing of Casual & Sick Leaves:
Unutilized Casual Leave and Sick Leave lapse automatically at midnight on December 31st each year and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

4.2 Earned Leave Carry-Forward Cap:
A maximum of 10 days of unutilized Earned Leave may be carried forward into the subsequent calendar year.

4.3 Encashment at Separation:
Accumulated EL beyond the carry-forward cap, up to a maximum of 30 days, is encashable upon resignation, retirement, or full separation based on basic salary.

6. PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT (POSH) FRAMEWORK

5.1 Zero Tolerance Mandate:
The organization enforces strict zero tolerance for sexual harassment, unwelcome advances, hostile environment creation, or quid pro quo demands.

5.2 Internal Complaints Committee (ICC):
A statutory ICC headed by a senior female leader conducts independent, confidential inquiries into POSH complaints within a 90-day statutory SLA.

5.3 Whistleblower Immunity & Protection Against Retaliation:
Complainants and witnesses receive absolute immunity against retaliation, adverse employment action, or workplace intimidation.

7. CONFLICT OF INTEREST, GIFTS & ABSOLUTE MOONLIGHTING BAN

6.1 Absolute Moonlighting Prohibition:
Employees shall not engage in secondary paid employment, freelancing, consulting, or side businesses without prior written approval from the Chief Executive Officer.

6.2 Gift & Corporate Hospitality Threshold:
Employees must not accept cash or gifts exceeding ¹2,000 / $25 from vendors or partners. Unsolicited gifts exceeding this

limit must be declared to HR within 48 hours.

8. PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINARY MATRIX & APPEALS PROCESS

Conduct violations trigger formal progressive disciplinary steps: Verbal Warning -> Written Reprimand Letter -> Suspensions without Pay / PIP -> Summary Dismissal for Gross Misconduct. Appeals may be lodged with the HR Grievance Panel within 7 working days.

VERSION CONTROL & REVISION HISTORY

Version 1.0 (Effective Date: 2026-01-01)

Author: Employee Relations | Approved By: CHRO | Summary: Initial comprehensive conduct & leave policy framework release